
BUYER TIPS
BUYING IN NC OR SC? CHECK THE TITLE.
KNOW WHAT YOU'RE REALLY BUYING.
Title, boundaries and easements come with every home
What a title policy protects, and what it doesn't
Here's what I'd check before closing
BUYER TIPS
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THE MARKET

CHARLOTTE METRO, NC + SC

SEPTEMBER 2026.

MEDIAN LIST PRICE	$424,950	−3.1% YoY
PRICE PER SQUARE FOOT	$217	−1.4% YoY
NEW LISTINGS	3,742	−7.5% YoY
PENDING LISTINGS	4,681	−5.9% YoY

Whatever the price, check the title and boundaries before you close.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, Charlotte-Concord-Gastonia, NC-SC metro, September 2026

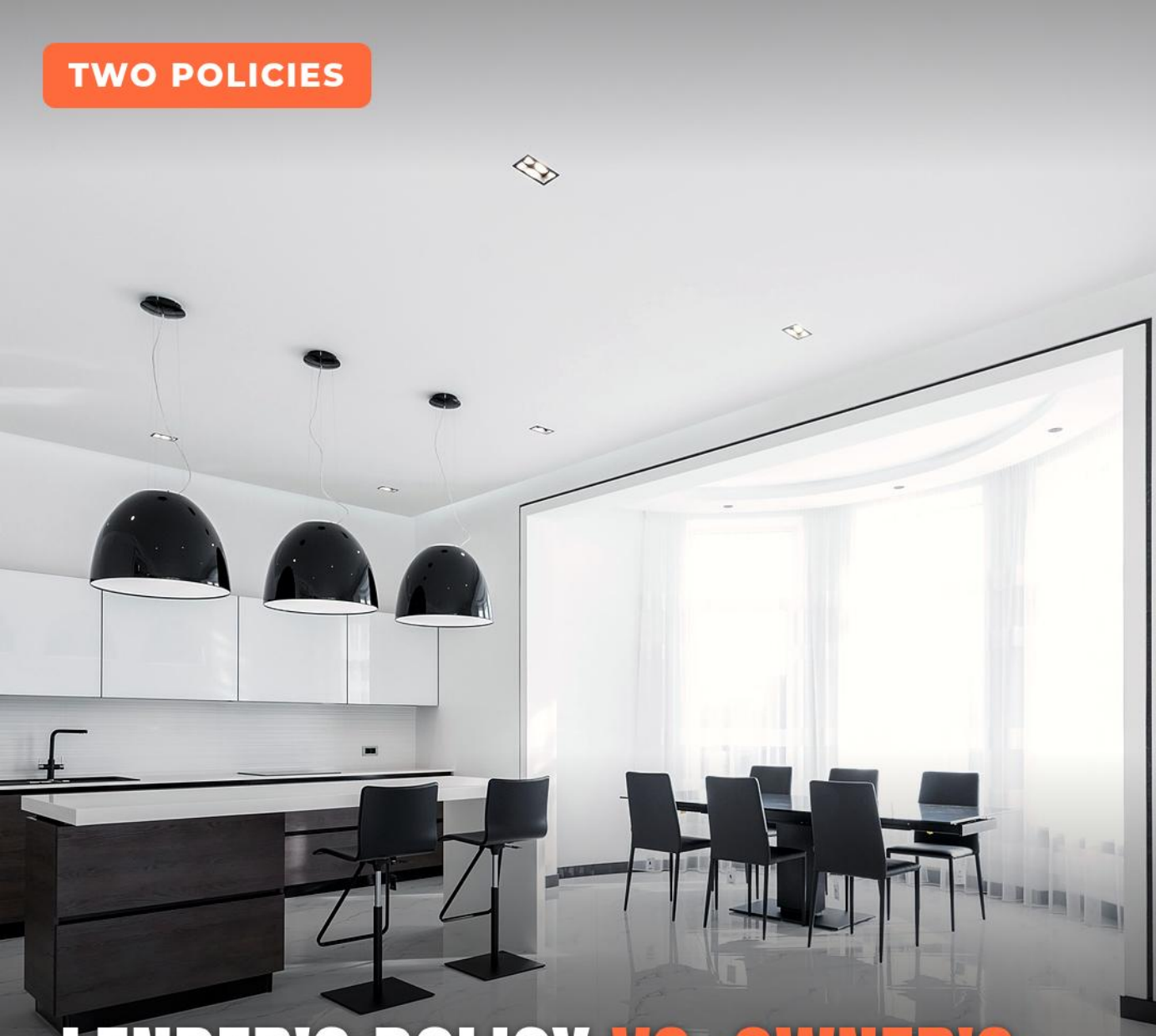
TITLE



TITLE MEANS OWNERSHIP.

- At closing, the deed shows the seller transferred ownership, or "title," to you
- Old claims can surface later, like unpaid taxes or unpaid contractors
- A title search reviews the public records before you close

TWO POLICIES



LENDER'S POLICY VS. OWNER'S.

- Most lenders require a lender's title policy
- It protects the lender's loan, not your equity
- An owner's policy is optional and can help protect your investment

SHOP AROUND



YOU CAN SHOP FOR TITLE.

- Look at section C, page 2 of your Loan Estimate
- Your lender must give you a list of local providers
- Buying both policies from one provider usually costs less in total



THE SURVEY

KNOW WHERE THE LINES ARE.

- A survey can show boundaries, easements and setbacks
- NC's standard offer form lists a survey as a due diligence item
- Order it early so results arrive before your deadline



EASEMENTS

READ THE LAND QUESTIONS.

- NC's disclosure statement (REC 4.22) asks about easements, shared driveways and encroachments
- It also asks about private roads and liens that could affect title
- SC's disclosure covers restrictive covenants and encroachments too



THE RULES

READ THE RULES THAT COME WITH IT.

- Covenants and HOA documents can set mandatory rules for the lot or home
- NC's standard offer form recommends reviewing covenants, bylaws and rules
- Ask if the association charges fees for documents



ASK FIRST

ASK QUESTIONS BEFORE YOU SIGN.

- Ask your closing attorney to walk you through the title results
- Ask what any listed exceptions mean for the home
- Compare the survey with what you saw on your tour

MY RECOMMENDATION



CLEAR TITLE, THEN COMMIT.

I recommend reviewing the title search, the survey and any HOA documents during due diligence, because they shape what you own and how you can use it. For legal questions about title, talk with a real estate attorney.

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